



05-12-2026 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0lbEurfHI4c
Publication Date	2026-05-13T10:30:40Z
Target Category	mcs

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Note: The transcript does not contain a formal statutory public hearing or committee work session held immediately prior to the call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Mr. Williams called the meeting to order, welcoming attendees and noting the presence of visitors and celebrations [00:03:03](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. Neal, Mr. Heater, Ms. Barnes Griffin, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Irwin, and Mr. White.
 - **Members Absent:** (None noted in the transcript roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Ryan Johnson and his child [00:02:19](#). The board also celebrated multiple student achievements, including art showcases, DOE visits to SIG schools, Latin honors awards, near-space balloon launches at Northside and Central, and recognized the Northside

Middle School eSports state championship team (Marvel Rivals) and Southside Middle School achievements [00:03:10 <U+2013> 00:45:15].

- **Approval of Minutes:** *The transcript does not contain explicit discussion or action regarding the approval of prior meeting minutes.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:47:17 Consent Agenda: Muncie Public Library Board Reappointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / District Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brief inquiry regarding the consent agenda items, noting the Muncie Public Library Board reappointment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:48:03 Financial Report & Common School Loan Term Extension**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Duron (Chief Financial Officer) & Mr. Jim Williams.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Duron reported on April financial results, noting a \$219,000 reduction in the state basic grant due to a lower February ADM count (down 40<U+2013>50 students) and savings from onboarding custodial staff. Mr. Williams and Mr. Duron reported on an excursion to Indianapolis to present to the Department of Education advisory (DoE AB) board regarding extending the repayment term of their \$12 million common school loan (with a current remaining balance of \$4.6 million) by 24 months, moving the final payoff from June 2028 to June 2030. The DoE AB board approved the request, which is slated for the State Board of Finance on May 19th/21st. This extension will reduce monthly payments from over \$220,000 to \$96,000, saving over \$500,000 in cash flow for the education fund in 2026 and \$1.1 million the following year. Long-term fiscal warnings regarding State Senate Enacted Act 1 (SEA 1) property tax reform were also discussed, highlighting looming operational deficits by 2029/2030.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:13:52](#).
- **00:48:33 Food Service Project Construction Manager Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Duron.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to award the Construction Manager as Constructor (CMC) contract to Core Construction for a summer food service project involving serving line revisions at Southside Middle School and new dishwashing equipment at Muncie Northside Middle School. Estimated total project cost is \$800,000 to \$1,000,000, with a 5% fee (approx. \$50,000) using federal food service funds while complying with the Davis-Bacon Wage Act.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:59:57](#).

- **01:00:07 Employee Handbook Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented updates to the employee handbook (last updated May 2025). Key changes include: (1) establishing a 90-day probation period for custodial staff, after which they become eligible for vacation and benefits; (2) incorporating amendment A regarding official closing/delay days and clarifying that custodial and maintenance staff are considered essential personnel during weather closures; and (3) updating page 24 to include attendance and evaluation records when considering employees for promotions, advancements, pay increases, or transfers.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:01:58](#).
- **01:02:09 Student and Family Support Guide (Handbook) Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff presenter (Mr. Reynolds / Administration).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual spring update to the 2026<U+2013>2027 student and family handbook, noting the document has been fully updated for ADA compliance. Updates include: new bullying notification timelines; a revised high school cell phone policy matching middle schools (requiring devices and smart watches to be powered off and stored in lockers during the school day, with exceptions for IEPs/504s or translation tools); updated attendance laws and definitions; and new general guidelines regarding artificial intelligence (AI) use and academic integrity for students and staff.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:13:37](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: The transcript does not feature a general public comment period or floor comments from external residents, as time was dedicated to student and administrative presentations (including Northside Middle School eSports and Southside Middle School mock trial student participants).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Muncie Central High School graduation is scheduled for June 1st, with board members arriving between 6:30 PM and 7:00 PM [01:14:10](#).
 - The next board meeting is scheduled for June 9th [01:17:12](#).
 - **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made and approved by voice vote [01:17:20](#).
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